

applications that are bare skeletons and get all their real functionality from components in the library project. Then, as you code and compile the library project, its assets are shared with the “real” projects that contain and are responsible for building the Web and desktop applications.

Follow these steps to create a Flex project that’s designed for the desktop in Flash Builder:

1. Choose File > New > Flex Project from the Flash Builder menu.
2. On the first screen of the New Flex Project wizard, set the project properties:
 - Project name: Fast Track
 - Project location: Use default location
 - Application type: Desktop
 - Flex SDK version: Use default SDK
 - Application server type: None
3. Click Next.
4. On the Configure Output screen, accept the default Output folder location and click Next.
5. On the final screen, set the Main application filename to MyDesktopApp.
6. Set the Application ID to com.mycompany.MyDesktopApp.
7. Click Finish to create the project and application.

You should see a starting Flex application open in the Flash Builder editor with a root element of `<s:WindowedApplication>`. In the Package Explorer view, you should see both the main application file and the XML-based application descriptor file MyDesktopApp-app.xml.

8. Delete the default `<fx:Declarations>` element from the new application.
9. Add a Label control to the application with a text property of Hello from AIR! and a fontSize style of 24. Place it 20 pixels from the top of the application and center it horizontally:


```
<s:Label text="Hello from AIR!" fontSize="24"
top="20" horizontalCenter="0"/>
```
10. Save and run the application.

The appearance of a basic Flex application differs depending on the hosting operating system. The magic of AIR is that you don’t have to recompile the application for different operating systems. When packaged with default settings in the application descriptor file, the version of AIR that’s currently hosting the application at runtime controls the application window’s look and feel.